

Ten Sentences About Cats

- 1 Cats were first domesticated in the Near East around 10,000 years ago, drawn to early farming settlements by the rodents in the grain stores.
- 2 An adult cat has 32 muscles in each ear, which lets it rotate its ears independently to pinpoint the source of a sound.
- 3 Domestic cats sleep between 12 and 16 hours a day, conserving energy for the short, intense bursts of activity that hunting requires.
- 4 A cat's purr vibrates at roughly 25 to 150 hertz, a frequency range associated with both self-soothing and tissue healing.
- 5 Unlike most mammals, cats walk with a direct register gait, placing each hind paw almost exactly in the print left by the front paw.
- 6 Whiskers are not decorative: they are deeply rooted touch receptors that help a cat judge whether a gap is wide enough to squeeze through.
- 7 Cats have a reflective layer behind the retina called the tapetum lucidum, which nearly doubles the light available to their eyes at night.
- 8 Adult cats rarely meow at each other; the vocalization is largely reserved for communicating with humans.
- 9 The righting reflex that lets a falling cat twist upright develops by about seven weeks of age and relies on an unusually flexible spine.
- 10 Every cat's nose print is a unique pattern of ridges and bumps, as individual as a human fingerprint.